

# Phase 2 User Experience

Preferred covered reading edition

**FINALIZED BASELINE | ALL THREE DECISION GATES CLOSED**

Fixed ten-minute holds and professional-confirmed overlap exceptions

# AESTHENDA CORE

## Phase 2 - User Experience Blueprint

**Version:** v2.2

**Status:** FINALIZED BASELINE - DG-01, DG-02, and DG-03 approved and reconciled

**Prepared:** September 7, 2026

**Authority:** AESTHENDA CORE v2.2 Master Blueprint, approved capability addendum, and approved DG-01 and DG-02/DG-03 governing amendments

This document replaces the abbreviated alignment review as the current Phase 2 working authority while preserving the review and early Independent Stylist draft. It broadens the persona to independent beauty and wellness professionals, removes team administration, adds first-class intentional overlap and guided booking-page customization, and retains compatible journeys and success measures.

### 1. Experience objective

Aesthenda is a personal business cockpit for one independent professional. It should feel upscale, calm, modern, expressive, and easy to operate during a busy day. It adapts to the professional's operating model without turning setup into enterprise administration.

The product shows its breadth progressively, focuses the next useful action, saves safely, explains consequences, and never hides money, policy, availability, or conflict facts.

### 2. Primary users

#### Independent owner-professional

Owns the business, performs services, manages schedule and clients, communicates, and collects payment. The professional often works from a phone, has short administrative windows, may use mixed tools today, and needs timing, payment, client history, and brand presentation to remain trustworthy.

Goals:

- publish a genuinely bookable, branded page quickly;
- understand and operate the day at a glance;
- support services with active work, processing time, buffers, and intentional compatible overlap;
- manage clients, notes, forms, consent, payment, cancellation, rescheduling, and rebooking without scattered records;
- shape policies and presentation without learning system terminology.

#### Client

Discovers services, sees real availability, chooses a time, supplies only necessary information, understands policies and payment terms, confirms securely, manages an appointment, completes forms/consent, and accesses history where enabled.

The client sees clear bookable choices, not private notes, restrictions, audit details, or the professional's outside-system management of rooms, chairs, stations, and equipment.

### 3. Experience principles

1. **Mobile first, desktop capable.** Every critical professional and client workflow works comfortably on a phone.
2. **Show the product, focus the next action.** Keep navigation available while Today emphasizes what needs attention.
3. **Use professional language.** Say Services, Availability, Clients, and Booking Page; do not leak provider, tenant, role, or workflow-engine terminology.

4. **Keep setup proportional.** Common controls appear first; optional locations, advanced rules, and integrations appear only when relevant. v1 never asks the professional to configure rooms, chairs, stations, or equipment.
5. **Save safely.** Drafts persist; interrupted changes preserve the last valid state; publication remains deliberate.
6. **Preview consequences.** Policy, schedule, payment, overlap, cancellation, and publication changes show their effect before confirmation.
7. **Use one booking brain.** Web, mobile, AI, voice, and integrations render the same canonical decision and do not calculate their own availability or payment truth.
8. **Make warnings specific.** Name the affected time, Appointment, segment, payment term, or policy source and offer a recovery path.
9. **Never hide money or policy.** Prices, deposits, tips, refunds, payment state, cancellation, rescheduling, consent, and relevant restrictions remain explicit.
10. **Celebrate outcomes, not clicks.** Mark publication, first booking, and first completed appointment; keep routine operations quiet.

## 4. Launch sequence

The professional completes only what is required to become bookable:

| Step | Professional action                                                                                 | Aesthenda response                                                                                                                                                                              | Completion evidence                                        |
|------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | Add at least one Service, including price presentation and active/processing timing where relevant. | Saves continuously and shows client-facing service preview.                                                                                                                                     | At least one valid public Service.                         |
| 2    | Set bookable Availability and choose whether compatible overlap is allowed.                         | Generates sample slots, shows policy source, and flags conflicts.                                                                                                                               | At least one genuinely bookable slot under current policy. |
| 3    | Add essential business and booking information.                                                     | Reuses it across the page, communications, and receipts.                                                                                                                                        | Required legal/contact/public facts validate.              |
| 4    | Review recommended policy settings or customize them.                                               | Labels recommendations as suggestions and previews client consequences.                                                                                                                         | A valid draft is explicitly accepted/published.            |
| 5    | Customize the Booking Page.                                                                         | Starts with a polished theme; supports colors, backgrounds, accents, font pairings, buttons, cards, density, logo, professional image, cover image, and approved assets within safe boundaries. | Theme validates without changing canonical booking facts.  |
| 6    | Preview mobile and desktop, complete a test booking, and publish.                                   | Runs one readiness check and shows live status, URL, share actions, and rollback-safe result.                                                                                                   | Public link exposes at least one real bookable time.       |

Extensive customization is optional. A professional may publish the recommended accessible theme and return to the designer later.

## 5. Information architecture

### Primary professional surfaces

- **Today:** launch checklist until published; current schedule, next appointment, actionable changes, payment issues, quick add, block time, and concise closeout after launch.
- **Calendar:** day/week/agenda views, appointment creation/change, availability overlay, blocks, processing segments, intentional-overlap presentation, and external-calendar status.
- **Clients:** search/list, profile, appointment/service history, preferences, private notes, photos, forms/consent, payment/invoice history, rebooking, duplicate review, and controlled merge.
- **Services:** service list/editor, pricing, active/processing segments, buffers, public visibility, forms, deposit/payment terms, overlap eligibility, and conditional delivery context. There are no v1 Resource fields.
- **Availability:** recurring hours, breaks, time off, date overrides, optional delivery context, and client-facing slot preview.
- **Booking Page:** business content, service ordering, theme editor, responsive live preview, readiness validation, test booking, publication status, and public link.
- **Payments:** processor connection, deposits/prepayment/card-on-file modes, balances, tips, refunds, external-payment recording, invoices, settlement, and reconciliation.
- **Communications:** confirmations, reminders, receipts, delivery status, templates, channel preferences, and consent-aware resend.
- **Analytics:** bookings, revenue, cancellation/no-show, rebooking, retention, and actionable quality indicators; no team comparisons in v1.
- **Settings:** business profile, policies, locations when enabled, notifications, account/billing, privacy/retention, security, and accessibility preferences.
- **Assistant:** visible only when an approved user-facing capability ships or is enabled; it uses canonical actions and confirmation gates.
- **Integrations:** payment, calendar, and other approved connections, scopes, health, last sync, and disconnect controls.
- **Activity:** understandable audit/activity history for consequential actions, publications, overrides, integrations, and automation.

Forms and consent live contextually under Services, Clients, Appointments, and Booking rather than requiring a primary navigation item. Invoices live under Payments. This preserves the master-blueprint surface inventory without losing earlier working detail.

### Navigation behavior

Desktop uses a persistent, collapsible navigation region. Mobile centers Today, Calendar, Clients, and a fast create action, with secondary surfaces in a clear menu. Current location in the product is always visible. Unavailable features are omitted or explicitly described as unavailable; team/users never appears in v1.

## 6. Professional journeys

### Journey A - Launch the Booking Page

1. **Arrive:** Today shows a short launch path and saved progress, avoiding empty-product anxiety.
2. **Add Services:** essentials first; advanced segment timing appears only when requested.
3. **Set Availability and overlap posture:** preview real slots and any overlap behavior before proceeding.
4. **Add business information and policy:** explain what clients will see and where each effective setting comes from.
5. **Customize:** update mobile and desktop previews live from a polished default.
6. **Review:** complete a test path and resolve one consolidated readiness list.
7. **Publish:** show committed live state, URL, sharing actions, and a clear failure/rollback path.

Success signal: the public page shows at least one genuinely bookable time and the professional can complete a test booking.

### **Journey B - Manage the workday**

1. **Start:** Today prioritizes appointments, changes, unpaid items, and only issues requiring action.
2. **Prepare:** appointment brief combines client history, selected Services, forms, notes, delivery context, and payment state.
3. **Check in:** one prominent action records arrival and time.
4. **Deliver:** glanceable segment timing shows active work, processing, next hands-on return, and compatible overlap on the Professional's calendar.
5. **Handle change:** create/move/shorten/cancel/block uses canonical preview and valid alternatives; warnings remain quiet but specific.
6. **Close:** optional summary separates unresolved actions from informational totals and shows the next day's first appointment.

Success signal: the day can be managed primarily from Today, Calendar, and appointment detail.

### **Journey C - Complete and rebook**

1. Confirm actual Services and authorized adjustments; preserve an audit trail when they differ from the booking.
2. Calculate service charge, deposit/prepayment credit, tax, discount, tip, and remaining balance.
3. Process an eligible Square method or record an external payment with clear verification status.
4. Separate service completion from final settlement; never present pending as settled.
5. Issue a receipt and approved follow-up without duplicate messaging.
6. Offer a simple rebooking window based on Service cadence and real Availability; allow explicit skip.

Success signal: completed service, payment record, Client history, and any future Appointment agree.

### **Journey D - Cancel or reschedule**

1. Show the Appointment, policy version/source, timing window, payment state, and request source together.
2. Preview fee, refund, deposit-transfer, Availability, and communication consequences.
3. For reschedule, calculate real alternatives rather than empty calendar gaps.
4. Confirm once, record before/after state, and emit one canonical change event.
5. Communicate the final time and financial outcome; return the released slot to Availability unless another rule blocks it.

Success signal: one authoritative Appointment state, one financial outcome, and an auditable history.

### **Journey E - Intentionally overlap compatible clients**

1. The professional enables overlap business-wide, for selected Services/processing segments, or considers it case by case.
2. Calendar and slot preview distinguish active work, released processing time, and the next required hands-on segment. They do not track room, chair, station, or equipment occupancy.
3. A fast add-to-overlap action explains why the new Appointment fits or identifies the exact overflow/conflict.
4. Normal compatible overlap saves under published policy. An outside-policy professional exception requires a warning-bound explicit confirmation and audit evidence.
5. Calendar stacks simultaneous Appointments without displaying a known conflict as ordinary free time.

DG-01 excludes Resource capacity from v1. DG-03 permits a professional-confirmed hands-on overlap exception and keeps it unavailable through public booking.

Shade only the exact conflicting interval amber on both affected appointments, keeping their normal colors elsewhere. Show the same highlight while placing or moving the appointment, before the confirmation warning, and retain it after approval while the conflict exists. Use no persistent overlap label or extra icon. Tap or click reveals the overlap duration, affected appointments, and

approval details. Provide the same details through keyboard interaction and screen-reader text without adding visible clutter.

With zero buffers and other rules satisfied, a 10:00-10:15 application, 10:15-10:45 released processing segment, and 10:45-11:30 haircut permit a fitting 30-minute public service in the processing gap. A 45-minute service at 10:15 ends at 11:00 and is not offered publicly. A manual booking previews amber from 10:45 to 11:00 on both appointments, warns of the 15-minute overlap, and requires Book anyway before saving. Go back returns to editing without committing. Approval preserves the 45-minute booking and existing haircut timing.

## **Journey F - Customize and publish the Booking Page**

1. Select a curated style direction or keep the recommended default.
2. Adjust supported colors, surfaces, type pairings, buttons, cards, density, logo, imagery, and business description.
3. Preview phone and desktop continuously with canonical Services, prices, policy, payment, consent, and Availability protected.
4. Accessibility validation explains unsafe combinations and preserves legible transactional content.
5. Publication requires deliberate confirmation; failure leaves the previous published version live.

Success signal: the page feels personal while its booking facts, flow, accessibility, and recovery remain trustworthy.

## **7. Client journeys**

### **Journey G - Discover and book**

1. Open a published page and understand the professional, Services, price presentation, duration, delivery context, and essential policy summaries.
2. Select one or more compatible Services where enabled.
3. See only real-time bookable times. Intentional overlaps may be offered only when the effective policy, Professional-calendar Availability, complete Service-segment fit, buffers, travel, existing Appointments, and holds pass.
4. Enter or verify Client details, complete required forms/consent, and see the exact terms/version being accepted.
5. A standard server-timed ten-minute hold protects checkout for every business; expiration or loss provides a plain explanation and recalculation path.
6. Satisfy the professional's published payment mode. Pending or failed external payment never appears as confirmed success.
7. Receive confirmation with date, time, time zone, Services, delivery instructions, payment state, and relevant policy.

### **Journey H - Manage an existing appointment**

1. Verify access before protected Appointment detail is disclosed.
2. View current time, Services, delivery information, payment status, required forms, and applicable policy version.
3. Preview client-allowed cancellation or rescheduling consequences.
4. Confirm the action, see one final outcome, and receive a consistent communication.
5. If self-service is outside policy, explain the boundary and provide a safe contact/recovery path without exposing internal restrictions.

## **8. Business-policies experience**

- Common controls first; advanced scopes and exceptions behind explicit optional sections.
- Plain-language labels with a concise effect statement and example.
- Each value shows its source: appointment override, Service, enabled Location, business, or starting recommendation.
- Recommendations are visible and editable, never represented as universal Aesthenda mandates.
- A recommendation becomes saved policy only after explicit acceptance/publication.

- Before saving or publishing, preview client-facing text and affected future behavior.
- Existing Appointments retain their accepted policy version.
- An authorized professional override shows consequences, requires explicit confirmation when consequential, and produces audit evidence.
- Platform security, isolation, integrity, processor, and legal boundaries are presented as non-configurable with a useful reason.

## 9. Required experience states

Every applicable workflow defines:

- first use and empty;
- loading and saved draft;
- validation error and field recovery;
- success and committed version;
- system error and retry guidance;
- offline or interrupted state;
- stale revision/state conflict;
- scheduling conflict and no Availability;
- normal compatible overlap, outside-policy overlap warning, and blocked public overlap;
- hold active, expiring, expired, and released;
- payment required, pending, failed, settled, refunded, and disputed where relevant;
- authentication, verification, permission, and step-up states;
- cancelled/expired action;
- delivery/integration degraded state;
- prior valid version/rollback recovery.

No Availability offers applicable alternatives such as another date, compatible Service combination, or enabled delivery context. It does not invent another professional in v1.

## 10. Accessibility requirements

- Full keyboard operation for professional and public workflows.
- Visible, consistent focus and logical focus order.
- Text scaling without clipping or loss of action access.
- Sufficient contrast for content, controls, focus, warnings, and transactional states; theme publication cannot weaken protected content.
- Clear labels, programmatic names, instructions, and error association.
- Status and validation communication that does not rely on color alone.
- Reduced-motion behavior and no motion-dependent completion.
- Comfortable touch targets and spacing for mobile operation during service work.
- Screen-reader-friendly headings, landmarks, tables, dialogs, live regions, and appointment/segment descriptions.
- Plain-language time, time-zone, price, policy, and payment announcements.

The exact conformance standard and audit method are Phase 8/11 approval items; this Phase 2 baseline does not invent them.

## 11. Usability validation plan

Validate with independent beauty and wellness professionals representing simple single-location, mobile/virtual, multi-location, processing-time, intentional-overlap, and no-overlap models, plus clients using mobile public booking.

Required scenarios:

1. Publish from a new account with one Service and valid Availability.
2. Understand a recommendation and replace it with a business choice.
3. Complete a test booking and recover from hold expiration.
4. Manage a busy day and find the next required hands-on segment.
5. Create a compatible overlap and interpret a blocked or warned overlap.
6. Cancel/reschedule with a deposit or other payment term.
7. Customize a theme and recover from failed validation/publication.
8. Complete booking and appointment management with keyboard, text scaling, and assistive technology.

Measure launch completion, median time to publication, preview/test-booking completion, time to create/move an Appointment, booking without manual coordination, public-step abandonment, payment failure recovery, cancellation/reschedule completion, accurate completed-payment state, rebooking rate, support requests, task success, comprehension, and accessibility defects. The primary launch measure is successful publication of a genuinely bookable page, not account creation.

## 12. Approved cross-phase decisions

- **DG-01 - APPROVED OPTION B:** v1 has no room, chair, station, waiting-area, equipment, pool, or capacity setup, calendar layer, availability input, assignment, reservation, conflict, or validation UI. The independent professional manages these outside Aesthenda. Resource scheduling may be introduced only after v1 through separately approved design.

- **DG-02 - APPROVED OPTION A:** All businesses use a fixed ten-minute booking hold, timed by the server from hold creation. There is no business, Service, or Appointment duration setting. Release early on explicit cancel/close; otherwise expire automatically. Confirmation revalidates the hold and current scheduling state; an expired hold cannot confirm from stale client state.

- **DG-03 - APPROVED OPTION B:** Public booking never offers or confirms a non-fitting hands-on overlap. The authenticated owner-professional may manually book it after a specific warning and explicit confirmation bound to the exact request and current affected revisions. Published policy alone cannot authorize a hands-on conflict. Record the warning, actor, time, affected Appointments and segments, policy version, confirmation, and outcome. Preserve the full booked duration unless the professional explicitly edits it; never silently shorten work or move an existing appointment.

## 13. Phase 2 acceptance record

The end-to-end professional and client journeys, navigation, screen-state requirements, policy experience, accessibility requirements, and usability plan are specified. Team complexity, v1 Resource scheduling, and hard-coded operating preferences are removed. Intentional overlap remains a Professional-calendar and Service-segment experience; guided booking-page customization is first class. The three recorded cross-phase gates are resolved.

**Phase status:** Phase 2 v2.2 baseline finalized and closed for DG-01 through DG-03. The decisions are propagated to the governing amendment, Phases 4-6 scheduling amendments, Phase Six handoff, and Phase Seven UI source. Later phase review and production implementation require their own authorization.